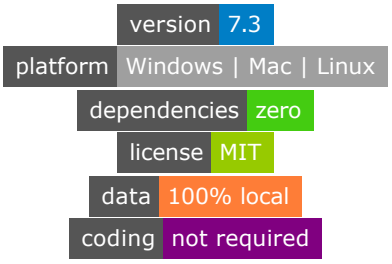
Chrome Starting Page Dashboard

Your personal homepage that lives on your computer -- beautiful, private, and truly yours.



한국어 버전 (Korean)

What Is This?

Every time you open your web browser (a program like Google Chrome that lets you visit websites), it shows a **start page** (the first page you see when the browser opens). Usually, that is just Google's search page or something the browser chose for you.

This project replaces that page with your own custom dashboard -- a beautiful, personal homepage where you can organize your bookmarks (favorite websites), write notes, manage to-do lists, track habits, and more.

The dashboard runs as a tiny **server** (a small program running quietly in the background on your computer, like a helpful assistant waiting for requests). It uses something called **Node.js** (explained later in the Requirements section) as its engine. Your data stays private -- nothing is ever sent to any company or server on the internet. You do not need to know how to code. You do not need to install complicated software. Just run one setup file, and you are done.

> **Three key points:**
>
> - **No coding knowledge required** -- double-click one file and the installation is done (this includes people who only use natural language or "vibe coding" to build software)
> - **Your data stays on your computer only** -- nothing is ever sent to any external server
> - **No extra software to install** -- it downloads what it needs and runs independently

Preview

> Replace these placeholders with actual screenshots of your dashboard.

Dark Theme	Light Theme

Bookmarks & Cards	Settings Panel

Features

📑 Bookmarks & Organization

- **Bookmark cards** -- group your favorite websites into neat categories (Work, Social, Shopping, etc.)
- **Multiple pages** -- split bookmarks across separate tabs when one page is not enough (e.g., "Work", "Personal", "Study")
- **Unified search** -- search your bookmarks, notes, to-dos, and events all at once with one keystroke
- **Smart paste** -- copy a website address (URL) and press Ctrl+V anywhere on the page; a category picker appears automatically
- **Drag and drop** -- drag links from Chrome's address bar directly onto a card
- **Dead link detection** -- automatically finds bookmarks that no longer work
- **Multi-select** -- hold Ctrl and click to select several bookmarks at once, then move or delete them together
- **Pin to top** -- pin your most important bookmarks so they always appear at the top of their card

🔍 Search

- **Web search** -- type in the search bar at the top and press Enter to search the web
- **Multi-search engine** -- switch between Google, YouTube, Naver, and others with one click
- **Unified search (Spotlight)** -- press `F` to search bookmarks, to-dos, notes, and calendar events all at once
- **Korean initial consonant search** -- type just the first consonants (e.g., "ㄴㅇㅂ") and matching bookmarks like "네이버" appear
- **Keyword shortcuts** -- type `yt cats` to search YouTube for "cats" directly
- **Command mode** -- in unified search, type `>settings`, `>theme`, `>timer`, etc. to run commands instantly

✅ Productivity Tools

- **To-do list** -- tasks with priority levels (high / medium / low), tags, due dates, and recurring schedules; drag to reorder; completed items automatically move to the bottom
- **Notes** -- create as many note cards as you need for simple text notes (multiple cards supported)
- **Calendar** -- monthly or weekly view with event creation and browser notifications
- **Pomodoro timer** -- a 25-minute focus timer with optional automatic 5-minute breaks (auto-session

continues cycles)
- **Habit tracker** -- daily checklist that resets every midnight

🎨 Appearance & Customization

- **Dark / Light theme** -- switch with one click (with a smooth circle transition animation), or automatically follow your computer's setting
- **6 accent colors** -- blue, purple, rose, emerald, amber, cyan
- **Custom backgrounds** -- upload your own images; with 1 image it stays fixed, with 2 or more they become a slideshow (ON/OFF toggle, adjustable interval, manual previous/next buttons)
- **Glass-morphism UI** -- adjustable card transparency (blur slider) and opacity (opacity slider) for a modern frosted-glass look
- **Layout presets** -- 4 types: Default, Compact, Wide, or Magazine
- **Custom CSS** -- for advanced users who want to write their own styling rules

☁️ Weather & Clock

- **Weather widget** -- shows current weather for your city using OpenWeatherMap (requires a free API key -- explained below)
- **World clock** -- display multiple time zones at the top of the dashboard (e.g., New York, London, Tokyo)

📅 D-Day Countdown

- Track important dates with "D-7", "D-3", "D-Day", "D+1" style countdowns
- Displayed at the top of the dashboard for quick reference
- Past dates show how many days have passed

⌨️ Keyboard Shortcuts

Key	What it does
`/`	Move cursor to the search bar
`F`	Open unified search (bookmarks + to-dos + notes + events)
`S`	Open settings
`E`	Toggle edit mode (shows card management buttons)
`1` through `9`	Jump to the 1st, 2nd, ... 9th card
`Esc`	Close any open popup or modal
`Ctrl+Z`	Undo the last action (delete, move, etc.)

🛡 Safety & Privacy

- **100% local** -- your data never leaves your computer; no accounts, no cloud, no tracking
- **Automatic backups** -- the server creates backups on a smart retention schedule, keeping up to 50 files
- **Full export / import** -- download everything (bookmarks, notes, settings, icons, backgrounds) as one JSON, Markdown, or HTML file
- **Trash with undo** -- accidentally deleted something? Press Ctrl+Z to bring it back (10-level undo stack -- you can undo up to 10 actions in a row)
- **Localhost only** -- the server only listens on `127.0.0.1` (your computer); nobody else on your network can access it
- **Zero dependencies** -- the server uses only built-in features of Node.js; nothing extra to download or update
- **Offline support** -- the dashboard works even without an internet connection (except weather)
- **Profiles** -- save and switch between different dashboard setups
- **Backup list and restore UI** -- browse all your backups with dates and sizes, and restore any one with a single click
- **Import preview** -- before applying an import, see a summary of exactly how many bookmarks, notes, and other items will be imported
- **Tab sync** -- if you have the dashboard open in multiple browser tabs, changes sync instantly between them (uses BroadcastChannel API)

Requirements

> "Requirements" means the things you need before you can start.

What	Why	How to get it
A computer	Windows 10/11, macOS, or Linux	You probably already have this
Google Chrome (or any browser)	To view the dashboard	Download Chrome
Internet connection	Only needed for the first-time setup	After setup, the dashboard works offline
Node.js	A small program that runs the dashboard in the background	**Windows:** the setup file downloads it for you automatically. **Mac/Linux:** install from nodejs.org

> **What is Node.js?** Think of it as a tiny engine that powers the dashboard behind the scenes. If the dashboard is a "car", Node.js is the "engine" that makes it go. It runs quietly in the background and uses very little memory (about 15 MB -- less than a single browser tab). On Windows, the setup file (`setup_windows.bat`) downloads a portable copy of Node.js automatically, so you do not need to install

> anything yourself. If Node.js is already installed on your system, it will use that; if not, it downloads a private copy just for this project.

Installation

💻 Windows (Easiest -- No Coding Needed)

> **Time needed:** About 2-5 minutes.

Step 1: Download the project

Download this project folder and place it anywhere you like.

Example: `C:\Users\YourName\Dashboard`

> Your Desktop, Documents folder, or any location is fine. Just avoid system folders like `C:\Windows` or `C:\Program Files`. Remember: if you delete this folder later, the dashboard goes with it, so put it somewhere safe.

Step 2: Run the setup

Open the folder and find the file called `setup_windows.bat`. It has a gear-like icon and looks like a small script file. **Double-click** it.

A black window (called "Command Prompt" -- a text-based way to give instructions to your computer) will appear with progress messages:

1. It checks if Node.js (the engine) is already on your computer
2. If not, it automatically downloads a portable copy (~30 MB -- this only happens once)
3. If Node.js is already installed system-wide, it uses that instead
4. The dashboard server starts in the background (no visible window)
5. Auto-start is registered so it launches every time you turn on your computer

Wait until you see **"Setup Complete!"** -- then the black window is safe to close.

Step 3: Open it in Chrome

Open Chrome and type this address in the **address bar** (the long text box at the very top of the browser window where you normally see website addresses):

```
http://localhost:1111
```

Then press **Enter**.

> **What does `localhost:1111` mean?** "localhost" means "this computer" -- you are telling Chrome to look at your own computer instead of the internet. "1111" is the **port** number (think of it as a door number -- explained more in the Settings section).

You are done! From now on, the dashboard starts automatically every time you turn on your computer -- no popups, no extra windows.

▶ What does setup_windows.bat actually do? (click to read)

🍎 Mac

> **Time needed:** About 3 minutes. You will need to type a few commands.

Step 1: Install Node.js

Go to nodejs.org and click the big green button on the website. Follow the instructions to install it.

Step 2: Open Terminal

You need to open an app called **Terminal** (a text-based window where you type commands to control your computer -- think of it as talking to your computer by typing instead of clicking):

- Press `Cmd + Space` on your keyboard (this opens Spotlight search)
- Type `Terminal` and press Enter
- A window with a text prompt will appear -- this is where you type commands

Step 3: Navigate to the project folder

Type the following command and press Enter. This tells Terminal to "go to" the folder where you put the project:

```
cd ~/Dashboard
```

> Replace `~/Dashboard` with the actual path to where you put the project folder. The `cd` command means "change directory" (go to a folder). The `~` symbol means your home folder.

Step 4: Give the setup file permission to run

```
chmod +x setup_mac.sh
```

> The `chmod` command gives the setup file permission to run. Mac requires this step for security.

Step 5: Run the setup

```
./setup_mac.sh
```

> The `./` prefix means "run this file in the current folder".

Step 6: Open it in Chrome

Open Chrome and go to:

```
http://localhost:1111
```

Step 7: Done!

The dashboard will auto-start every time you log in. You can close Terminal now.

🐧 Linux

1. Install Node.js from nodejs.org or your package manager (e.g., `sudo apt install nodejs`)
2. Open a **terminal** (a text window for typing commands -- most Linux systems open it with `Ctrl+Alt+T`)
3. Navigate to the project folder and run the server:

   ```
   cd ~/Dashboard
   node server.js
   ```

4. Open Chrome and go to `http://localhost:1111`

▶ Set up auto-start with systemd (click to read)

How to Use

Setting It as Your Chrome Start Page

This makes the dashboard appear every time you open Chrome:

1. Open Chrome
2. Type `chrome://settings/onStartup` in the address bar and press **Enter**
3. Select **"Open a specific page or set of pages"**
4. Click **"Add a new page"**
5. Type `http://localhost:1111` and click **Add**

> Now every time you open Chrome, your dashboard will greet you.

Setting It as Your New Tab Page (Optional)

If you also want to see the dashboard when you open a **new tab** (not just when Chrome starts):

1. Install the free Chrome extension New Tab Redirect
2. Set the redirect URL to `http://localhost:1111`

Basic Usage Guide

What you want to do	How to do it
Add a bookmark	Type or paste a URL in the input box at the bottom of any card, press Enter
Add by dragging	Drag a URL from Chrome's address bar and drop it on a card
Add by pasting	Copy a URL, then press Ctrl+V anywhere on the page -- a category picker appears
Rename a bookmark	Double-click on a bookmark's name
Edit a bookmark	Right-click on a bookmark > "Edit"

What you want to do	How to do it
Delete a bookmark	Hover over a bookmark and click the X button (you can undo with Ctrl+Z)
Reorder bookmarks	Drag a bookmark up or down within a card
Move to another card	Drag a bookmark from one card to another
Move to another page	Right-click on a bookmark > "Move to another page"
Pin a bookmark to top	Right-click on a bookmark > "Pin to top"
Select multiple	Hold Ctrl and click several bookmarks, then use the action bar
Add a new card	Click the **"+ Add Card"** button at the bottom of the page
Open settings	Press the `S` key or click the settings icon

Pages

If you have many bookmarks, split them across multiple **pages** (like having separate tabs for "Work", "Personal", "Study"):

- **Add a page:** Settings > Widgets > Page Management > "+ Add Page"
- **Switch pages:** Click the tabs at the top of the dashboard
- **Move a category to another page:** In edit mode (press `E`), click the page button on a card's title bar
- **Move a bookmark to another page:** Right-click on a bookmark > "Move to another page"

Cards

Your dashboard is made of **cards**. Each card serves a different purpose. Think of them like different sections on your desk -- one for links, one for notes, one for tasks, and so on.

Card	What it does
Bookmarks	A collection of links organized by category
Notes	Simple text notes -- create as many note cards as you need
To-do	Task list with priority levels, tags, due dates, recurring tasks, and drag-to-sort
Calendar	Monthly or weekly calendar view with event creation
Pomodoro	A 25-minute focus timer with auto-session (press play to start)
Habits	Daily habit checklist that resets every midnight

To add a new card, click the **"+ Add Card"** button at the bottom of the page. In edit mode (press `E`), you can also change a card's width by clicking the size button on the card.

Search Features

What you want to do	How to do it
Search the web	Type in the search bar at the top and press Enter
Change search engine	Click the icon to the left of the search bar (Google, YouTube, Naver, etc.)
Search everything at once	Press the `F` key -- searches bookmarks, to-dos, notes, and events together
Korean initial consonant search	Type just the first consonants (e.g., "ㄴㅇㅂ") and matching bookmarks appear
Keyword shortcuts	Type `yt cats` to search YouTube for "cats" directly
Run commands	In unified search, type `>settings`, `>theme`, `>timer`, etc.

Settings & Customization

Changing the Port Number

> **What is a "port"?** Think of it like a door number on a building. Your computer has thousands of these "doors", and each program uses a different one. The dashboard uses door number 1111 by default. If another program is already using that door, you need to pick a different number.

The dashboard runs on port `1111` by default. To change it:

Method	How
From the dashboard (easiest)	Settings > Data > Server Management > enter new port > click "Change"
Double-click a file	Run `set-port.bat`, type a number (e.g., `8080`), press Enter
Edit a text file	Create or edit `port.conf` in the project folder, write just the number inside
Command line	Run `node server.js 8080`

> After changing the port, update your Chrome start page address too (e.g., `http://localhost:8080`).

Themes and Appearance

Setting	How to change it
Dark / Light theme	Click the moon/sun icon at the top of the dashboard (smooth circle transition)
Follow your OS theme	Settings > General > Theme Mode > "Follow OS"

Setting	How to change it
Accent color	Settings > General > Accent Color (6 choices: blue, purple, rose, emerald, amber, cyan)
Glass effect	Settings > Appearance > adjust card blur (blur slider) and opacity (opacity slider)
Layout	Settings > Appearance > Layout (Default / Compact / Wide / Magazine)
Custom CSS	Settings > Appearance > Custom CSS (for advanced users)

Background Images

What you set	What happens
1 image	The image stays fixed as your background
2 or more images	Slideshow mode becomes available with ON/OFF toggle, adjustable interval (1 minute to 24 hours), and manual previous/next buttons

How to set backgrounds:

1. Go to **Settings > Appearance > Background Images**
2. Click **"Add Images"** to upload pictures from your computer
3. If you uploaded 2 or more images, a slideshow toggle appears -- turn it ON or OFF as you like
4. When slideshow is ON, choose a rotation interval (1 minute to 24 hours) and use the manual previous/next buttons anytime
5. Click **"Reset All"** to go back to the default background

Weather Widget

1. Go to **Settings > General > Weather**
2. Get a free API key from OpenWeatherMap (sign up for a free account -- it takes 1 minute)
3. Paste the API key and type your city name (e.g., "Seoul", "New York")
4. Choose Celsius or Fahrenheit

World Clock

1. Go to **Settings > General > World Clock**
2. Click **"+ Add Clock"**
3. Enter a label (e.g., "New York") and select the timezone

D-Day Countdown

- Go to **Settings > Widgets > D-Day** to add important dates
- Shows "D-7", "D-3", "D-Day", "D+1", etc. at the top of the dashboard
- Past dates show how many days have passed

Data Safety

Where is my data stored?

All your data lives in the `data/` folder inside the project. This folder is **never deleted** by setup, restart, or update scripts. Nothing is ever sent to any external server.

Think of it like keeping a diary in your desk drawer -- it stays in your folder on your computer, and only you can see it.

Automatic Backups

The server automatically creates backups on a smart retention schedule. You do not need to do anything.

Time range	How many backups are kept
Last 7 days	Every backup is kept
Days 8 through 30	One backup per day
Older than 30 days	Automatically removed
Maximum total	50 backup files

Backups are stored in `data/backups/`.

Backup List and Restore

You can browse and restore any backup directly from the dashboard:

1. Go to **Settings > Data**
2. You will see a **list of all backups** with their dates and file sizes
3. Click **"Restore"** next to any backup to restore your dashboard to that exact point in time

This is useful if you accidentally deleted something or changed your settings and want to go back.

Manual Export and Import

Action	Steps
Export as JSON (save everything to one file)	Press `S` > Data tab > click "Export" > a file downloads containing all your bookmarks, notes, settings, icons, backgrounds, and profiles
Export as Markdown	Press `S` > Data tab > choose Markdown format

Action	Steps
Export as HTML	Press `s` > Data tab > choose HTML format
Import (restore from a file)	Press `s` > Data tab > click "Import" > select your backup file > see a **preview** showing exactly how many bookmarks, notes, to-dos, and other items will be imported > confirm to apply
Quick restore (drag and drop)	Drag and drop any backup JSON file directly onto the dashboard page

> **Import preview:** Before any import is applied, you will see a summary screen showing the count of each type of item (e.g., "42 bookmarks, 5 notes, 12 to-dos"). This lets you verify the file is correct before overwriting your current data.

> Save your export file to a USB drive or cloud storage (like Google Drive) for extra safety.

Moving to Another Computer

1. On the old computer: **Export** your data (Settings > Data > Export)
2. Copy the downloaded file to the new computer (USB, email, cloud drive -- anything works)
3. On the new computer: set up the dashboard, then **Import** the file (Settings > Data > Import)
4. Done -- your dashboard looks exactly the same

> **Alternative method:** Copy the entire `data/` folder from the old computer and paste it into the same location inside the project folder on the new computer.

What Happens on Reinstall?

Running `setup_windows.bat` again will:

1. **Create a safety backup** of your current data first (saved as `safety-before-setup.json` in the backups folder)
2. **Keep all your existing data untouched** -- nothing is deleted
3. **Re-register auto-start** so the dashboard launches on boot
4. **Restart the server** with the latest files

Your bookmarks, notes, to-dos, and settings will still be there. Nothing is lost.

Updating to a New Version

When a new version is released:

1. **Export your data first** (Settings > Data > Export) -- just to be extra safe
2. **Replace the project files** with the new version (overwrite the old files with the new ones)
    - Your `data/` folder will not be overwritten because it contains your personal data -- **do not touch or delete it**
3. **Run** `setup_windows.bat` (or `setup_mac.sh` on Mac) again, or double-click `restart.bat`

4. Your data is preserved automatically

▶ If the page looks broken after updating (click to fix)

Uninstalling (Clean Removal)

Windows (Recommended)

1. Double-click `uninstall.bat`
2. It will automatically:
    - Stop the server
    - Remove auto-start from Windows Registry and Startup folder
    - Ask if you want to keep or delete your data (you choose)
    - Clean up log files and temporary files
3. After that, you can safely delete the entire project folder
4. In Chrome, go to `chrome://settings/onStartup` and remove the localhost entry

No traces left on your system. No other programs are affected. This program does not modify system files, so deleting the folder is all it takes for a clean removal.

Mac

The easiest way: open Terminal, navigate to the project folder, and run the uninstall script:

```
cd ~/Dashboard
chmod +x uninstall_mac.sh
./uninstall_mac.sh
```

The script will stop the server, remove auto-start, and ask if you want to keep or delete your data.

▶ Manual uninstall (if you prefer)

Linux

Open a terminal and run these commands:

```
sudo systemctl stop dashboard
sudo systemctl disable dashboard
sudo rm /etc/systemd/system/dashboard.service
sudo systemctl daemon-reload
```

Then delete the project folder.

> After uninstalling on any platform, go to `chrome://settings/onStartup` in Chrome and remove the localhost entry.

Troubleshooting

- ▶ **The page will not open ("This site can't be reached")**
- ▶ **"Port already in use" error**
- ▶ **Bookmark icons are not showing**
- ▶ **Data is not saving ("Save failed" message)**
- ▶ **The page looks broken after an update**
- ▶ **The server does not auto-start after reboot**
- ▶ **I want to restart the server**
- ▶ **A black window briefly appears on startup**
- ▶ **I want to move data to another computer**

File Structure

> Here is what each file in the project does. You do not need to understand all of this -- it is here for reference.

```
Chrome_Starting-Page/
|
|  === Setup & Management Tools ===
├── setup_windows.bat ........... One-click setup for Windows (double-click this!)
├── setup_mac.sh ................ One-click setup for Mac
├── restart.bat ................. Restart the server if something is wrong
├── uninstall.bat ............... Clean removal tool (Windows)
├── uninstall_mac.sh ............ Clean removal tool (Mac)
├── set-port.bat ................ Change the port number
├── start_hidden.vbs ............ Helper that starts the server invisibly
├── run_server_background.bat ... Helper for running server in background
|
|  === The Dashboard Itself ===
├── server.js ................... The server (the engine that powers everything)
├── index.html .................. Page structure (the skeleton of the dashboard)
├── style.css ................... Visual design (colors, fonts, layout, animations)
├── script.js ................... Dashboard logic (what happens when you click)
├── sw.js ....................... Offline support (works without internet)
├── manifest.webmanifest ........ Browser app configuration
├── package.json ................ Project metadata (name, version)
|
|  === Auto-Generated (do not edit) ===
├── port.conf ................... Your custom port number
├── .server.pid ................. Server process info
|
|  === Your Files ===
├── assets/ ..................... Background images and app icons
|   ├── icon-192.svg             App icon (small)
|   ├── icon-512.svg             App icon (large)
```

```
│   └── background_custom.jpg     Your custom background
│
└── data/ ....................... YOUR DATA (the most important folder!)
    ├── bookmarks.json              Your bookmarks
    ├── config.json                 Your settings
    ├── notes.json                  Your notes
    ├── todos.json                  Your to-do items
    ├── events.json                 Your calendar events
    ├── ddays.json                  Your D-Day countdown dates
    ├── usage.json                  Usage statistics
    ├── trash.json                  Deleted items (recoverable)
    ├── icons/                      Cached bookmark icons
    ├── profiles/                   Saved profiles
    └── backups/                    Automatic backup files
        └── safety-before-setup.json    Pre-setup safety backup
```

> The `data/` folder contains all your personal data. Keep this folder safe and you can always restore your dashboard.

▶

Technical Details (for curious readers)

License

This project is licensed under the MIT License.

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In plain language:

- You are free to use this software for any purpose
- You are free to modify it however you like
- You are free to share it with others

Changelog

See CHANGELOG.md for the full version history.

If you like this project, please give it a star!

You do not need to know how to code to have your own beautiful dashboard.